

IDS11072
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 3:30 pm CST on Tuesday 18 August 2026
for the period until midnight CST Friday 21 August 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A cold front moving through the Bight, directs a northerly flow over South Australia this evening. The front will clip the south on Wednesday, before clearing to the east late. A high pressure ridge is expected to approach South Australia on Thursday from the west and continue to move east over the state on the weekend. Weak troughs clip the southeast in a broad westerly flow on Thursday and Friday.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: Westerly 15 to 20 knots, reaching up to 25 knots offshore in the late afternoon. Seas: 1 to 2 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Winds: Westerly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots offshore early in the morning. Winds becoming variable about 10 knots in the morning. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres inshore, increasing to 2 to 3 metres offshore. Weather: Becoming cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: Variable below 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning westerly in the late afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Winds: Westerly 15 to 20 knots becoming variable about 10 knots in the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming northwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the middle of the day then becoming variable about 10 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: South to southwesterly below 10 knots. Seas: Below 0.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots turning west to northwesterly in the evening. Winds reaching up to 25 knots offshore in the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres offshore. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 90% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Winds: Westerly 15 to 25 knots decreasing to 10 to 15 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday, then decreasing to 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning, then tending west to southwesterly 3 metres around midday. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: West to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres inshore, increasing to 3 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Cloudy.

Central Coast

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Strong Wind Warning for Tuesday for Central Coast

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 25 knots turning northwesterly 20 to 25 knots in the evening. Winds reaching up to 30 knots in the west in the evening. Seas: 1 to 2 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm later this evening.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Strong Wind Warning for Wednesday for Central Coast

Winds: Northwesterly 20 to 25 knots turning westerly 15 to 25 knots early in the morning. Winds reaching up to 30 knots in the west in the late morning. Seas: 1.5 to 2.5 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres, tending westerly 2.5 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: West to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots tending west to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday, then decreasing below 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Westerly 2.5 to 3 metres, tending southwesterly 3 metres by early evening. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 3 metres during the evening. Weather: Cloudy.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Strong Wind Warning for Tuesday for South Central Coast

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 25 knots, reaching up to 30 knots in the evening. Winds tending north to northwesterly 20 to 25 knots in the late evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 2 metres west of Kangaroo Island later in the evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm later this evening.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Strong Wind Warning for Wednesday for South Central Coast

Winds: North to northwesterly 20 to 25 knots tending west to northwesterly 15 to 25 knots early in the morning. Winds reaching up to 30 knots during the day. Seas: 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres, tending westerly 2 to 3 metres around midday, then increasing to 2.5 to 4 metres later in the evening. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the early morning.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: West to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots tending west to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Westerly 2 to 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres west of Kangaroo Island. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: Westerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots, reaching up to 25 knots offshore in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres offshore. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Strong Wind Warning for Wednesday for Upper South East Coast

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots, reaching up to 30 knots south of Salt Creek during the morning and early afternoon. Winds turning west to northwesterly during the morning and early afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres south of Salt Creek. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, tending westerly 2 to 2.5 metres by early evening. Weather: Partly cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the early morning.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: West to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Westerly 2 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: Westerly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots, reaching up to 25 knots offshore in the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres offshore. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Strong Wind Warning for Wednesday for Lower South East Coast

Winds: Northwest to northeasterly 20 to 30 knots tending northwesterly in the morning then tending westerly in the evening. Seas: 2 to 3 metres. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres, tending westerly 2 to 3 metres later in the evening. Weather: Cloudy. Near 100% chance of rain. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: Westerly 15 to 25 knots. Seas: 1.5 to 2.5 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Swell: Westerly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: Westerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Beachport during the afternoon. Swell: West to southwesterly 3 to 4 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending north to northwesterly in the evening. Winds reaching up to 25 knots near the Yorke Peninsula coast in the late evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Port Neill to Port Victoria. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm south of Cowell to Wallaroo later this evening.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Winds: Northwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning westerly 10 to 15 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday, then decreasing to around 1 metre during the afternoon. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: Northwesterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable about 10 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Port Neill to Port Victoria. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots decreasing to about 10 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 15 to 20 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm later tonight.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots turning westerly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre by early evening. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: Northwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning westerly below 10 knots during the afternoon and evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: West to southwesterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Tuesday 18 August until midnight

Winds: Northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending northerly 15 to 25 knots in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres later in the evening. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm later this evening.

Forecast for Wednesday 19 August

Winds: North to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots tending west to northwesterly 15 to 25 knots early in the morning. Seas: 1 to 2 metres. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning, then tending westerly 1.5 to 2.5 metres around midday. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm through the Backstairs Passage in the early morning.

Forecast for Thursday 20 August

Winds: West to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots tending west to southwesterly below 10 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Westerly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 21 August

Winds: Westerly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 pm CST Tuesday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.